Who Jesus Is

John 1; Luke 1–2; Mark 2; 4; Matthew 16–17

The big idea: Every promise in the story arrives in a baby born in Bethlehem. Jesus is Immanuel, God with us: truly God, who forgives sins, rules the sea, takes God's name, and receives worship, and truly man, who grew tired, hungry, and wept. One Person, two natures. And he asks each of us: who do you say that I am?

Before you meet: Read

John 1:1–18 | Luke 2:1–20 | Mark 2:1–12; 4:35–41 | John 8:56–59 | Matthew 16:13–17; 17:1–8

Open (5 minutes)

Before you started this study, who did you think Jesus was? Where did that idea come from?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"In the beginning was the _____, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God." *(John 1:1)*

"And the Word became _____ and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory." *(John 1:14)*

"They shall call his name Immanuel" (which means, God _____ us). *(Matthew 1:23)*

"Who then is this, that even the wind and the _____ obey him?" *(Mark 4:41)*

"Truly, truly, I say to you, before _____ was, I am." *(John 8:58)*

"You are the _____, the Son of the living God." *(Matthew 16:16)*

Discuss

1. John says the Word became flesh. What does it tell you about God that he came himself rather than only sending a message? *John 1:1–14*

2. The first to hear the news were shepherds on the night shift. Why do you think God announced his Son to them? *Luke 2:8–20*

3. The disciples were more afraid after the storm was calmed than during it. Why? *Mark 4:35–41*

4. Which of Jesus' claims or actions strikes you as the strongest evidence that he is God? *Mark 2:5–12; John 8:58; 20:28*

5. Jesus got tired, hungry, and wept. How does his full humanity change the way you pray to him? *John 4:6; 11:35; Hebrews 4:15*

6. Jesus asked, Who do you say that I am? What is your honest answer today? *Matthew 16:15–17; John 20:31*

Apply this week

Start reading the Gospel of Mark, one chapter a day. Keep a list of every time Jesus does something only God can do, and every time he shows he is truly human. At the end of the week, write one honest paragraph answering: who do you say Jesus is?

Memory verse

"And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory, glory as of the only Son from the Father, full of grace and truth."

John 1:14

Pray

Thank God that he came to us himself in his Son. Worship Jesus as truly God, and thank him that as truly man he knows your weakness. Ask the Father to show you who Jesus really is, as he showed Peter.

LEADER NOTES · LESSON 19

Who Jesus Is

Session plan (about 70 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read John 1:1–14 aloud together. Then read Mark 4:35–41.
10 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
30 min	Discuss: choose 4 of the 6 questions. Questions 1, 4, and 6 matter most.
5 min	Walk the group through the I Am chart and the One Person, Two Natures diagram in the full lesson.
10 min	Apply and pray. Introduce the memory verse and the reading for Lesson 20 (Mark 1; Matthew 5–7).

Main points to land

1. Jesus is the fulfillment of every promise in the story so far. He is Immanuel, God with us (Matthew 1:23; 2 Corinthians 1:20).
2. The eternal Word, who was with God and was God, took a true human nature by the virgin conception and was born in Bethlehem (John 1:1, 14; Luke 1:35; 2:7).
3. Jesus is truly God: he forgave sins, ruled the sea, took God's name, and received worship (Mark 2:5–12; 4:41; John 8:58; 20:28).
4. Jesus is truly man: he grew, tired, hungered, and wept, yet without sin. One Person, two natures, without conversion, composition, or confusion (WCF 8.2).
5. He came to seek and save the lost and to give his life as a ransom. Each of us must answer his question: who do you say that I am? (Luke 19:10; Mark 10:45; Matthew 16:15).

Answer key (Observe)

1. Word
2. flesh
3. with
4. sea
5. Abraham
6. Christ

Questions people will ask

If Jesus is God, who was he praying to? Is he the Father?

No. There is one God in three Persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. The Son is with God and is God (John 1:1), so he can pray to the Father without being the Father. Whoever has seen Jesus has seen the Father (John 14:9) because the Son perfectly reveals him, not because they are the same Person.

Did Jesus stop being God when he became a man?

No. Philippians 2:7 says he emptied himself by taking the form of a servant. He added a human nature to the divine nature he always had, and he set aside the glory that was his right. He remained fully God and became fully man (Colossians 2:9; WCF 8.2).

Do we have to believe in the virgin birth?

Matthew and Luke both teach it plainly (Matthew 1:20–23; Luke 1:34–35), and Christians have confessed it from the earliest creeds. It shows that salvation comes from God, not from human effort, and that Jesus is both truly human, born of Mary, and the holy Son of God.

Wasn't Jesus just a good moral teacher?

A merely good teacher does not forgive other people's sins against God, claim God's name, accept worship, or say that seeing him is seeing God. His hearers understood him and tried to stone him for blasphemy (John 10:33). Either his claims are false, or he is who he said he is.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you for sending your Son, the Word made flesh, Immanuel, God with us. Open our eyes, as you opened Peter's, to see who Jesus really is. Help us worship him as truly God and trust him as truly man, our merciful High Priest. May each of us answer his question with Thomas: my Lord and my God. Amen.